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CIO Backs Refugee Free Ports

The CIO's 5,000,000 members, acting through their president, Philip Murray, today urged President Roosevelt to set up free ports in this country for "refugees from Hitler Europe able to reach our shores."

Murray informed Adolph Held, chairman of the Jewish Labor Committee, that the CIO had sent an urgent message to Mr. Roosevelt and the War Refugee Board demanding that they act immediately.

Murray told the Jewish Labor Committee that "there is nothing we can do to bring back to life the millions of Jews and non-Jews cruelly done to death by the

Nazi and Fascist hordes; we can and must, however, save those who still may be rescued."

Temporary Haven

"Free ports will offer the homeless victims shelter for as long as they are forced to remain refugees. They will return to their homelands as soon as these are liberated by the armies of the United Nations," Murray wrote to Held, "In behalf of the CIO, I endorse the plan and hope to see it implemented without delay."

Support by the CIO places some 12,000,000 union members behind the free port plan originally proposed by Post columnist, Samuel Grafton. AFL President

William Green has also endorsed the proposal.